

BMT 2024 – the in-Person Experience

By Kevin Z.

8:40 AM PST – Power Round

Thousands of sleepy students file into their assigned rooms for the first of many math problems that they will be seeing on this fun day. Upon seeing the problems, however, the drowsiness leaves their bodies as teams scramble to work through an innovative problem set centered around a topic not commonly seen in competitive mathematics - Origami! Being the only proof-based round at BMT, olympiad excellers can show off their skill sets.

10:45 AM PST – Individual Round

Directly after the Power round, competitors quickly make their way to their assigned rooms to either take the General round, a 25 question test around AMC 12 difficulty, or a combination of 2 focus rounds from the 4 offered topics – Algebra, Geometry, Discrete, and Calculus. Unlike the other rounds offered at BMT, there are no teammates to rely on; the Individual round is the ultimate test for mathematical aptitude – allowing skilled mathletes to separate themselves..

2:30 PM PST – Guts Round

After a quick break from math problems, students get back into the action with another team based round – this time with a little more strategy... In the Guts round, teams are given sets of 3 problems at a time, only being able to receive the next set upon submitting answers for the current one, making precision a must. "Guts" is probably the most lively round of the day – hundreds of students are discussing problems in one auditorium.

5:00 PM PST – Activities

Exhausted competitors file out of the Guts round, ready to take a well-deserved break. The fun of BMT is not over yet though – students can choose between testing their intuition with the Estimathon, creating mathematical nonsense with Fraudulent Math, showing off their Calculus skills with the Integration Bee, combining their physical strength and Mathematics skills with the Plank Countdown, or even taking a break from math completely with some fun origami.



6:45 PM PST – Awards

Hundreds of students, coaches, and parents chatter anxiously awaiting the conclusion to the day's events. With each and every name that appears on the projector, a sense of relief goes off in the room; yet, anxiety builds for those who have not been called yet. At the end of the day, only a few participants are worthy of achieving an award at BMT; yet, it is a something that every mathlete who attends desires deeply. While awards are great things to aim for, the true joy felt by a competitor should stem from the holistic experience offered at BMT – the competitive scene, nice problems, and most importantly – the Cal atmosphere.

Thanksgiving Math Crossword

By Kevin Z. & Sophia S.

See Answers on the Next Page!

ONE DOWN

Adam, Betty, Charlie, and David are seated at the four corners of a rectangular picnic cloth, all integer distances away from the Cranberry Sauce that exists somewhere on the cloth. Let a be the distance Adam is from the Cranberry Sauce, b the distance Betty is from the Cranberry Sauce, c the distance Charlie is from the Cranberry Sauce, and d the distance David is from the Cranberry Sauce. Assuming that the child furthest from the Cranberry Sauce is 24 units away, the child closest to the Cranberry Sauce is 7 units away, find the sum of all possible values for the average of a, b, c , and d .

TWO DOWN

After months of pleading, Charlie finally convinced his parents to let him purchase a pair of shoes and a t-shirt from his favorite store's Black Friday sale. There are two options for the purchase – Charlie can either utilize the buy one get one free promotion which eliminates the cost of the cheaper item, or get 40% off the total value of his purchase. Suppose that both deals cost the same amount of money – \$28.50. What is the price of the cheaper item?

THREE ACROSS

Thanksgiving always lies on the fourth Thursday of November; if Thanksgiving lies on the 28th in 2024, what day will it lie on in the year 2030?

ONE ACROSS

Every Thanksgiving, Alice and Bob are required to rake the lawn before relatives come over; this task usually takes 120 minutes if they are working together. If the integer a represents the amount of time Alice would take to rake the lawn alone, and the integer b represents the amount of time Bob would take to rake the lawn alone, find the number of ordered pairs (a, b) where $a < b$.

1.	2.
3.	

